

RULE: Adjectives in Arabic must AGREE with their noun in 4 ways: Gender, Number, Definiteness, Case.

The 4-Way Agreement Table

Agreement	Rule	Example
1. Gender	Fem noun → fem adjective	بنت صغيرة = a small girl
2. Number	Plural noun → matching plural adj	رجال شرفاء = noble men
3. Definiteness	ال on noun → ال on adjective	الكتاب الجديد = THE new book
4. Case	Subject=damma, object=fatha, gen=kasra	كتاب من كتاب كبير = of a big book

Special Rule — Non-Human Plurals

RULE: Non-human plural nouns (things, animals) ALWAYS use FEMININE SINGULAR adjective.

Arabic	Meaning	Why
كتب كبيرة	big books	كبرى = books (inanimate) → fem sing adjective
بنايات جديدة	new houses	جديدة = houses (inanimate) → fem sing
رجال شرفاء	noble men	شرفاء = men (human) → plural adjective

★ This non-human plural rule is famous in Arabic — it trips up even advanced students!

★ Quranic: **وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ آلِهَتِهِمْ كَارِهُونَ** = and they have righteous deeds — **وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ آلِهَتِهِمْ كَارِهُونَ** (deeds, inanimate plural) + **وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ آلِهَتِهِمْ كَارِهُونَ** (fem sing adj)

★ Human plurals: **وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ آلِهَتِهِمْ كَارِهُونَ** = sincere believers — both plural